Chang'an Dublin International College of Transportation
Coláiste Iompair Idirnáisiúnta Chang'an Dublin

RURAL & LANDSCAPE PLANNING

CDIC BSc Module
Spring semester
5 ECTS

Lecturer:
Dr Ana Peric Momcilovic

- **Overview of the module content**

  main concepts and approaches

- **Operational details**

  module objectives
  core thematic units
  core reading material
  semester assignments & exam procedure
  grading system

Rural vs. urban areas

- We live in an increasingly ‘urban-age’

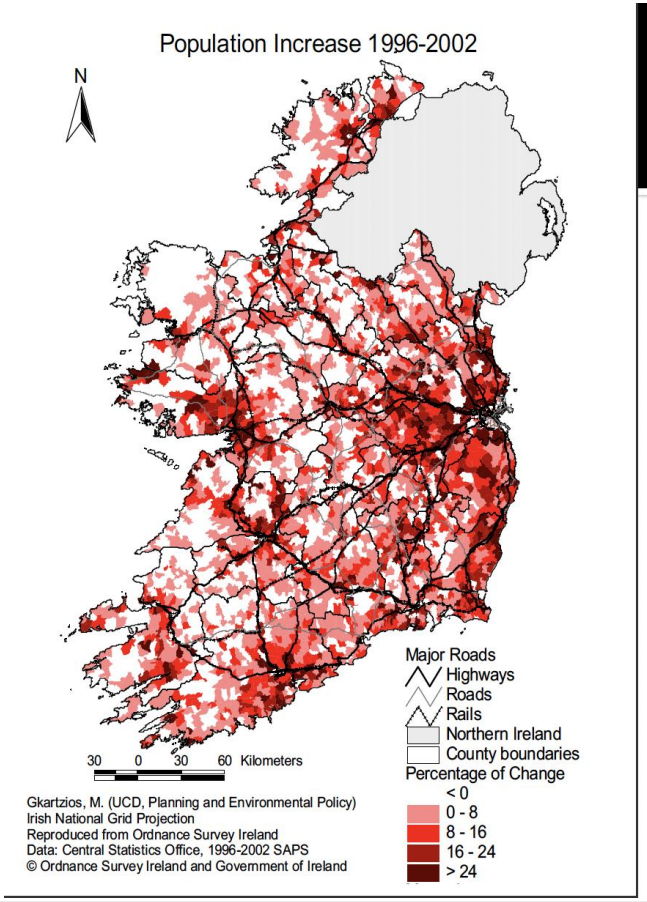
- In an urban world, is **rural** planning important?

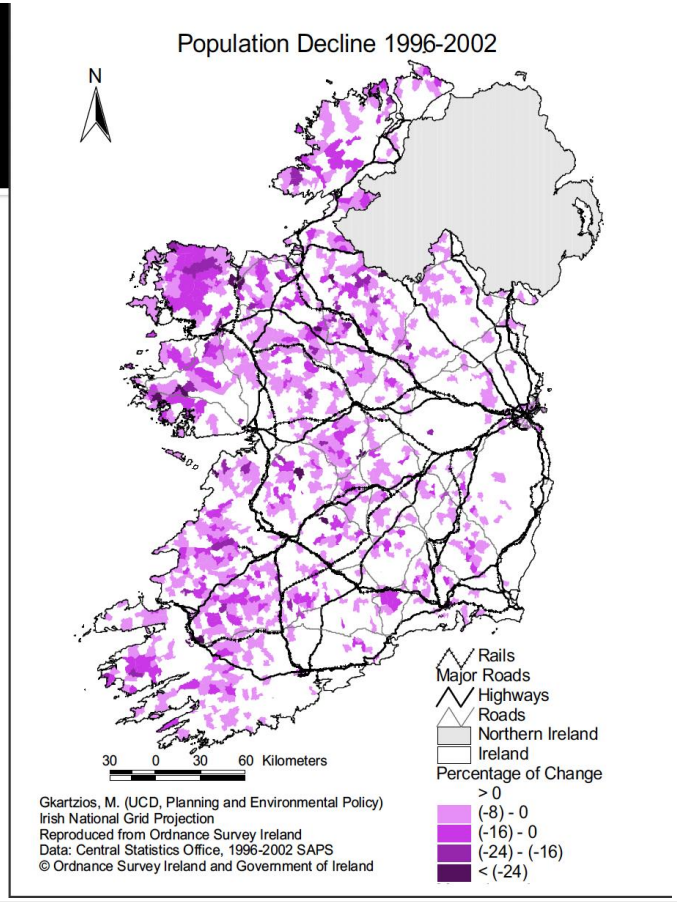
What is rural?
Rural (planning) 'myths'

- We often think of rural places as remaining fairly **static and unchanging**
- Rural often viewed as synonymous with **agriculture**
- A **'one size fits all' approach** is often applied
- Rural planning issues often seen as a **local issue**
- Rural and landscape planning is often viewed as a **barrier to change** – 'stops things happening'

What is rural?

Rural (planning) 'myth': static & unchanging





What is rural?

Rural (planning) ‘myth’: rural = agriculture

production **consumption** **mass tourism**

What is rural?
New perspectives

- A living landscape
- A working landscape
- A zero-carbon landscape
- A tourist landscape
- A heritage landscape
- A biodiverse landscape

MULTIFUNCTIONAL LANDSCAPES

What is rural planning?

- Rural planning is about developing and protecting physical and human capital and addressing the at times conflicting goals of **economic development and resource conservation.**

- It encompasses both the development of **agriculture and natural resources** – minerals, forests, fisheries, and scenery – and the conservation of these along with improving **the access of rural people to infrastructure, education, housing, and amenities**.

- Rural planning aims to bring about **economic development** yet maintain the **sustainability of renewable resources** and **reduce income disparities**.

Main themes

Rural **Change**

- Social and demographic transformations
- Economic restructuring

Rural **Development**

- Economic and community development; governance

Rural **Planning**

- Managing rural resources
- Mediating conflicts

Rural areas

>> advantages:

produce food and raw materials, amenities and ecosystem services, and are sources of productivity growth and technological innovation

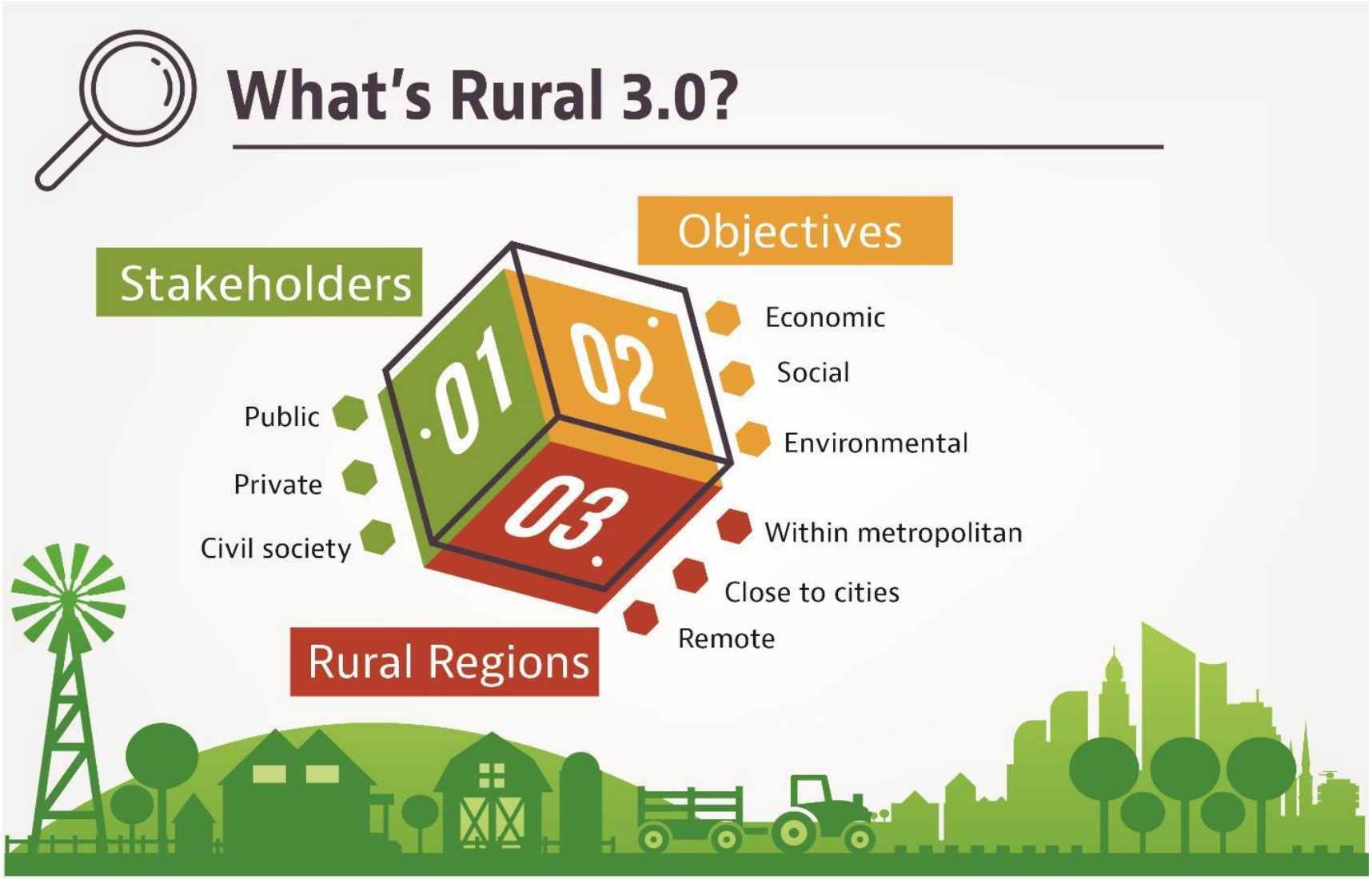
>> challenges:

competition from lower wage countries, declines in trade, lack of technologies, ageing population

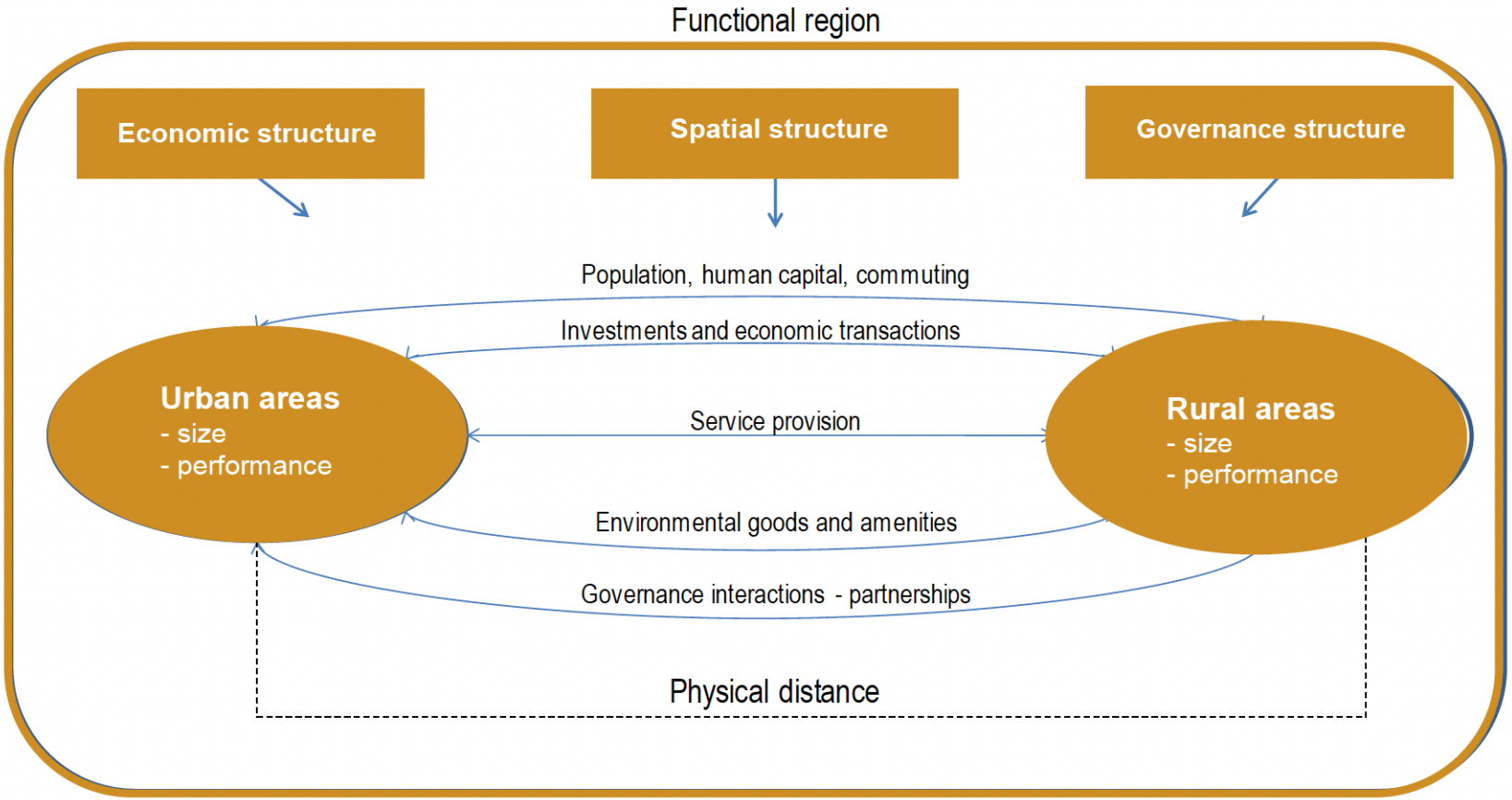
>> EVOLUTION OF RURAL DEVELOPMENT

Evolution of rural development

	Traditional Paradigm:	New Rural Paradigm:	Rural Policy 3.0:
objective	equalisation	competitiveness	well-being
rural definition	non-urban	variety of places	specific classification
	POLICIES >>	***The New Rural Paradigm* (OECD, 2006)**	***The Rural Policy 3.0 Framework* (OECD, 2019)**

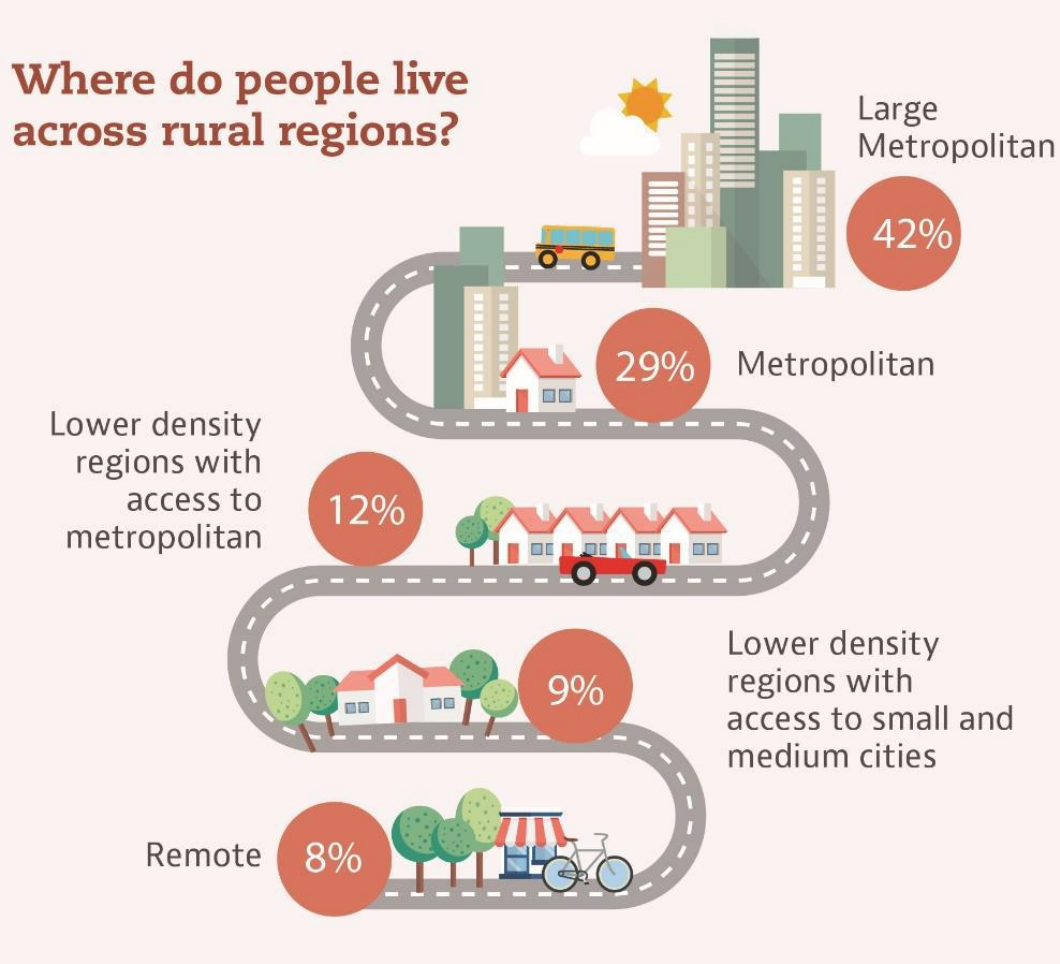

What's Rural 3.0?
Stakeholders
Public
Private
Civil society
01
Objectives
02
Economic
Social
Environmental
03
Rural Regions
Within metropolitan
Close to cities
Remote

1 Rural areas are diverse and have distinct needs



Source: OECD (2013), Rural-Urban Partnerships: An Integrated Approach to Economic Development, http://dx.doi.org/10.1787/9789264204812-en.

1 Rural areas are diverse and have distinct needs



2 Globalisation affects rural areas

- **the rise of global value chains (GVC)**

  about 70% of international trade today involves GVCs, as services, raw materials and manufactured goods shifted to emerging economies

- **orientation towards services**

  decline in agriculture and manufacturing

WHICH RURAL AREAS?

>> well-connected lower density regions have the potential to benefit greatly from dynamic urban markets

2 Globalisation affects rural areas

NEW RURAL ECONOMY

>> should go **beyond just exporting tradable goods** and integrate into GVC and export services

>> need to continue to **specialise and focus on core areas** of advantage to compete in the global economy

NEW RURAL ECONOMY IN EMERGING ECONOMIES

>> interest in technologies to **increase agricultural productivity**, **produce energy**, and **manage land and water resources** in sustainable ways

2 Globalisation affects rural areas

NEW RURAL ECONOMY

Exporting technical services and expertise: a key growth driver for rural economies

More investment and visitors; political, social and cultural links strengthen rural prosperity

NEW RURAL ECONOMY IN EMERGING ECONOMIES

2 Globalisation affects rural areas

NEW RURAL ECONOMY

no dichotomy between developed and emerging economies

NEW RURAL ECONOMY
IN EMERGING ECONOMIES

3 Social trends drive rural change

- **population ageing and migration**

  >> to provide innovations in **leisure, health and social care services**

  >> to provide an **attractive offer and integrate** newly arrived migrants

  >> to provide **flexible work arrangements, new housing designs, and community infrastructure** (relevant during COVID)

3 Social trends drive rural change

- **urbanisation**

peri-urban regions (rurban): zones of transition from rural to urban

>> include **rural interests in decision-making**, and that those rural places can foster linkages with cities

>> involvement of:

i) public sector – multi-level governance
ii) private sector – for-profit firms and social enterprises
iii) third sector – nongovernmental organisations and civil society

3 Social trends drive rural change

- **technological breakthroughs**

  >> open up new **production possibilities** and **choices about where people live and work**

  >> digitalisation and new technologies (e.g., 3D printers, delivery drones, autonomous vehicles, and augmented reality) can further **reduce the cost of moving people and goods and delivering services**

  >> rural areas will be able to offer a **quality of life** and **amenities** attractive to people with skills and capital

4 Environmental pressures drive rural change

- **technological breakthroughs**

problems:

- UN Paris Agreement: limit temperature increase to 1.5 C above pre-industrial level
- 60% of the global population will face water issues by 2050

>> investment and technologies associated with **renewable energy** and **the circular economy**

The circular economy refers to the shift in industrial production to reduce waste and minimise impacts on the natural environment with the aim of gradually decoupling growth from the consumption of natural resources.

4 Environmental pressures drive rural change

Environmental Benefits

- Natural resources protected
- Biodiversity and ecosystem services sustained
- CO2 emissions reduced
- Climate resilience improved

Rural Development

Social and Economic Benefits

- Jobs and Skills
- Sustainable businesses, new markets and products
- Economically viable and prosperous rural community
- Social inclusively

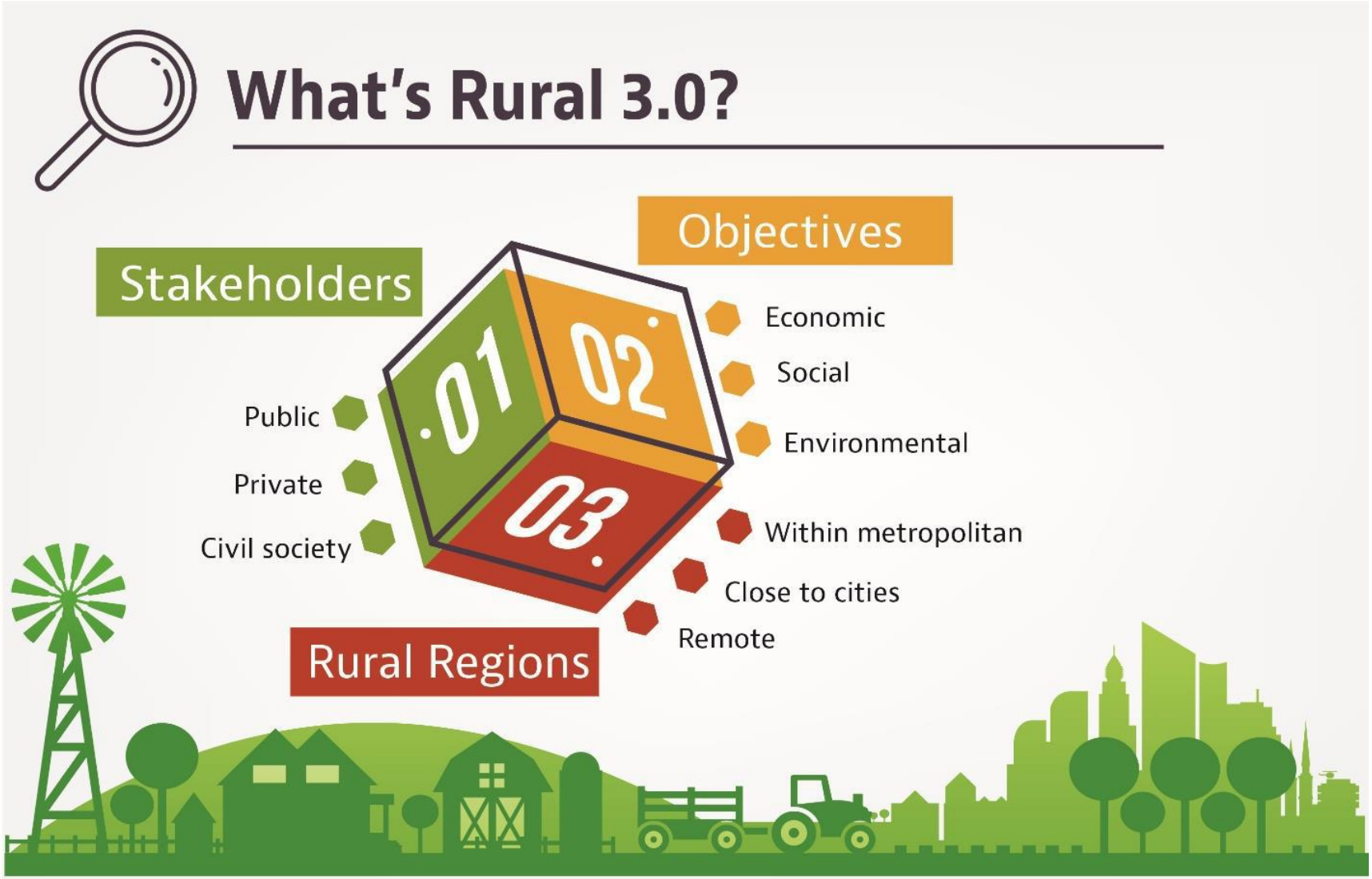
Opportunities

Policy frameworks that allow rural areas to:

- Facilitating the development of renewable energy
- Identifying ways to valorise ecosystem services
- Promoting the circular and bio-economy
- Increasing the supply of minerals and metals linked to the renewable energy transition
- Working with regions dependent on carbon intensive sectors to develop new economic opportunities

Baseline

- Recognise that climate policies have different effects of urban and rural populations
- Ensure considerations of rural people are taken into account - build trust, understand what matters most and navigating interests
- Enhancing policy coherence across sectors such as climate change and economic development


What's Rural 3.0?
Stakeholders
Public
Private
Civil society
Objectives
Economic
Social
Environmental
Rural Regions
Within metropolitan
Close to cities
Remote
01
02
03

Module objectives

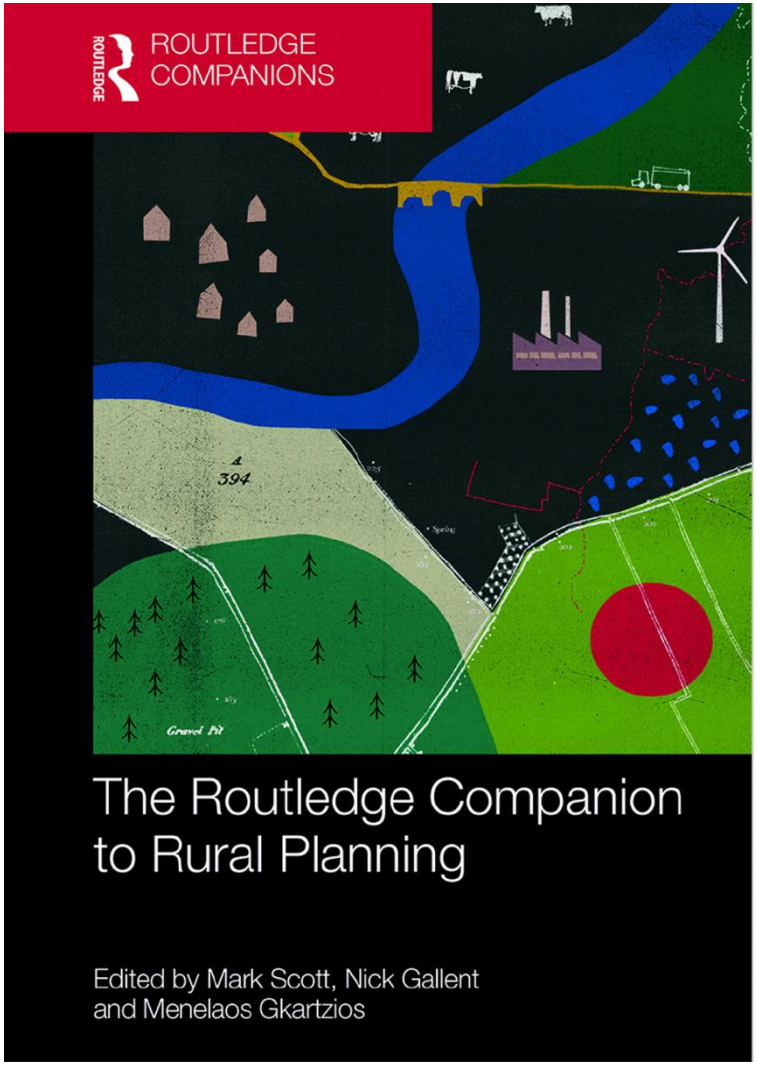
On completing this module, students will be able to:

1. Critically evaluate theories of rural restructuring and explain why some rural areas decline while others successfully adapt.
2. Distinguish between different types of rural places and assess their specific challenges in relation to demographic, economic, and environmental pressures.
3. Defend appropriate rural development strategies by synthesising evidence on their effectiveness in achieving economic, social, and environmental outcomes.
4. Argue for planning interventions that balance competing land-use demands (agricultural production, conservation, housing, and infrastructure) within specific rural contexts.
5. Analyse how transport connectivity shapes rural accessibility and economic opportunities, using evidence from integrated development initiatives.

Core thematic units

	Week (date)	Content	Module hours
	2 (10.03)	Introduction	2
1	2 (11.03)	Defining rurality	2
	3 (17.03)	The scope of rural planning	2
	3 (18.03)	The new rural economy	2
2	4 (24.03)	Social and demographic rural change	2
	4 (25.03)	Rural development & governance	2
	5 (31.03)	Energy and resources	2
	5 (01.04)	Rural settlement, planning and design	2
	6 (07.04)	National rural planning: Switzerland	2
3	7 (14.04)	National rural planning: China	2
	9 (29.04)	National rural planning: China	2
	11 (12.05)	Semester task	2
	11 (13.05)	Semester task	2
	12 (20.05)	Closing lecture	2
	13 (26.05)	Final exam	1

Core reading material



Semester assignments and exam procedure

Description	Timing	Component Scale	Must Pass Component	% of Final Grade	Component Repeat Offered
Exam (In-person): A 60-min written exam (20 multiple-choice questions)	Week 13	Graded	No	50	No
Group Work Assignment: Presentation: A 6-minute group presentation	Week 11	Graded	No	50	No

Grading system

% to Grade Conversion [CHD to UCD]			Grade to % Conversion [UCD to CHD]			Module Remediation Grades In-module Resits Resits Repeats					
Lower%	Upper%	UCD Grade	UCD Grade	Median %	Grade Point	Rem1	Rem2	Rem3	Rem4	Rem5	Resit
0	0	ABS	ABS	0	0	ABS(R)					
0	0	NM	NM	0	0	NM(R)					
0	20	FM-	FM-	10	0	FM-(R)					
20	40	FM	FM	30	0	FM(R)	F(R)				
40	60	FM+	FM+	50	0	FM+(R)					
60	61.67	D-	D-	61	2	C-(R)	D-(R)	D(R)	D+(R)	PR	P(R)
61.68	63.35	D	D	63	2.2	C(R)	CRM				
63.36	64.99	D+	D+	65	2.4	C+(R)					
65	68.33	C-	C-	67	2.6	B-(R)					
68.34	71.66	C	C	70	2.8	B(R)					
71.67	74.99	C+	C+	74	3	B+(R)					
75	78.33	B-	B-	77	3.2	A-(R)					
78.34	81.66	B	B	80	3.4	A(R)					
81.67	84.99	B+	B+	84	3.6	A+(R)					
85	89.99	A-	A-	88	3.8						
90	94.99	A	A	93	4						
95	100	A+	A+	98	4.2						

Thank you for your attention!